Findings Hoffenheim W

Clustering results

Hoffenheim were closely clustered with patient teams at k = 2 and k = 3. Then at k = 4, they were switched to central cluster. The margins for k = 3 and k = 4 were quite close.

Like patient teams

Hoffenheim were not one of the most active teams when it comes to progressive passing, and they were patient for their strength but not direct in build up. Their goal kicks were mostly short, and more of their box entries were via carries. They were slightly less active in engaging in counterpress actions. They had significantly fewer shots from counter attacks.

Like central teams

A significant proportion of their carries into the final third ended up centrally. They were particularly indirect in build up, tended to go short in goal kicks, and had more box entries via carries.

Pitch profile

A quarter of their attacks went down the middle. Right side was more favoured than left side, especially with touches.

Formations and typical XI

Hoffenheim mostly used 4-2-3-1 and 4-3-3 formations. While only using back three formations 2% of the time, they used wingerless formations 11% of the team, mostly the 4-1-2-1-2 formation.

For their main formation 4-2-3-1, goalkeeper, center backs, and left winger were the only stable positions. Most other positions saw significant rotations, with Linder being another regular player but was usually rotated between two full back positions.

Similar teams

Hoffenheim were built similarly to Manchester City and Duisburg, while played similarly to Bayern. These were the three teams that were in Hoffenheim's top five teams overall.

Appendix

The full Hoffenheim team report (PDF).